

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

## TOP LINE

- The story of the day: a new NASUWT survey finds 74% of teachers say poor pupil behaviour hurt their health and wellbeing last year, up from 62% in 2022.
- DfE launched a £22.5m Enrichment Expansion programme yesterday for 400+ disadvantaged schools, funding clubs, sport and volunteering from January 2027 - Sheffield secondaries are among those included.

→ **For your school:** Worth flagging to pastoral/enrichment leads now, ahead of January.

## DATES FOR THE DIARY

**7 Oct 2026** — National Alternative Provision Conference examines SEND reform and inclusion-first accountability.

**8 Oct 2026** — DfE pupil premium quarter 2 payments for 2026/27 made to academies.

**16 Oct 2026** — Midday deadline for Sheffield secondary school applications for September 2027 entry (national deadline 31 Oct).

**26-30 Oct 2026** — Sheffield schools' autumn half term.

## ■ NATIONAL: POOR BEHAVIOUR 'CORRODING' TEACHER HEALTH, UNION WARNS

- **NASUWT survey links severe pupil behaviour to worse teacher health.** Among teachers facing severe incidents, 70% reported headaches/migraines (v 61% of others) and a fifth said they'd been pushed or shoved by a pupil; only a third felt their employer dealt with incidents effectively. ([Schools Week](#) / [NASUWT](#))

→ **For your school:** Worth checking your incident-reporting and staff-support routes are actually being used.

## ■ NATIONAL: ENRICHMENT FUNDING REACHES DISADVANTAGED SCHOOLS, SHEFFIELD INCLUDED

- **£22.5m programme pairs 400+ schools with Enrichment Co-ordinators.** Delivered by the Youth Sport Trust, the scheme funds school clusters in deprived areas - including Sheffield sites - to map gaps in clubs, music, sport and volunteering, with support starting January 2027. ([GOV.UK](#) / [DfE](#))

## ■ SEND: PRIVATE SPECIAL SCHOOLS OPT OUT OF ADMISSIONS DUTY

- **Schools Week investigation finds independent special schools dropping off the Section 41 register.** Section 41 status normally obliges a school to admit any pupil named in their EHCP; some private providers are opting out to control their own capacity as the SEND places crisis and EHCP requests keep rising nationally. ([Schools Week](#))

→ **For your school:** Worth checking a setting's current Section 41 status before naming it in any MAPs pupil's EHCP.

## ■ SOUTH YORKSHIRE: HOUSE FIRE DELAYS ROTHERHAM PRIMARY'S START

▪ **Trinity Croft CofE Primary's school day was pushed back after a blaze shut the road.** South Yorkshire Fire and Rescue sent six engines to a house fire on Dalton Lane, Rotherham, on Monday morning; the school delayed its start to 10.30am while the road was closed and smoke cleared. ([The Star](#))

## JARGON-BUSTER - SECTION 41 REGISTER

Came up in today's SEND story:

The DfE list of independent special schools approved to admit pupils on request. Being listed means a school must take a pupil if they're named in their EHCP, like a maintained school would; providers can choose to come off the list to control their own admissions.

## MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

**School+** is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

## SOURCES MONITORED

*Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.*

| Source                                                | Type             | What we track                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| OFFICIAL & STATUTORY                                  |                  |                                                             |
| <a href="#">DfE / GOV.UK</a>                          | Government       | Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics          |
| <a href="#">Ofsted</a>                                | Government       | Inspection framework, report cards, annual report           |
| <a href="#">Explore Education Statistics</a>          | Government data  | Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data            |
| <a href="#">House of Commons Library</a>              | Parliament       | Neutral briefings on bills and policy                       |
| RESEARCH & EVIDENCE                                   |                  |                                                             |
| <a href="#">Education Endowment Foundation</a>        | Research         | Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching           |
| <a href="#">NFER</a>                                  | Research         | Assessment, workforce, disadvantage                         |
| <a href="#">Education Policy Institute</a>            | Think tank       | Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap                    |
| <a href="#">Institute for Fiscal Studies</a>          | Think tank       | School funding and spending analysis                        |
| <a href="#">FFT Education Datalab</a>                 | Data analysis    | Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions           |
| INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS                    |                  |                                                             |
| <a href="#">The Difference</a>                        | Charity          | Whole-school inclusion; “Who’s Losing Learning?”            |
| <a href="#">IPPR</a>                                  | Think tank       | Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform                      |
| <a href="#">Youth Endowment Fund</a>                  | Research         | What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion            |
| <a href="#">Centre for Social Justice</a>             | Think tank       | Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy                |
| <a href="#">Whole School SEND</a>                     | Network          | SEND practice, resources and reviews                        |
| SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY                             |                  |                                                             |
| <a href="#">Schools Week</a>                          | Press            | Breaking sector news and investigations                     |
| <a href="#">Tes</a>                                   | Press            | Practice, policy and workforce                              |
| <a href="#">The Guardian (Education)</a>              | Press            | National coverage and comment                               |
| X (monitored)                                         | Social           | DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use |
| LOCAL & REGIONAL                                      |                  |                                                             |
| <a href="#">The Star (Sheffield)</a>                  | Local press      | Local schools and Ofsted outcomes                           |
| <a href="#">Sheffield City Council</a>                | Local government | Council decisions, funding and local strategy               |
| <a href="#">South Yorkshire MCA &amp; Careers Hub</a> | Regional         | Regional skills, careers and funding                        |

**Connect Daily** is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

*For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.*